

Module 4: Drivers of Migration

Service Learning Project

Layered Drivers in Our Community: Country-Conditions Research for Casework

Overview

Support a legal aid or immigrant services organization by producing supervised country-conditions or driver-mapping summaries that help staff understand why their clients migrated.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Identify key drivers in real cases (UG 1)
- Explain push/pull complexity beyond single-cause stories (UG 2)
- Analyze case examples (UG 3)
- Recognize multi-causality (UG 4)

Suggested community partners

- Immigration legal aid organizations
- Refugee resettlement caseworker teams
- Migrant rights advocacy groups needing background research
- Public defender or pro-bono asylum support projects

Project steps

1. Meet the partner to select 1–2 origin countries or corridors relevant to their caseload.
2. Research economic, political, environmental, and violence-related drivers using credible sources (UNHCR, IOM, World Bank, academic literature, country reports).
3. Build a layered driver map showing how drivers interact (not a simple push/pull list).
4. Have the partner review for accuracy and usefulness; revise.
5. Deliver the summaries in the partner's preferred format and walk staff through them.
6. Write a reflection on how the research changed your understanding of 'why people migrate.'

Deliverables

- Country-conditions/driver summary (partner keeps)
- Layered driver interaction map (visual)
- 2-page reflection on multi-causality

Time commitment

15 hours.

Ethics requirements

Students work from public sources only and never access client files or case details.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Source quality and accuracy 30%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: source quality and accuracy is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: source quality and accuracy is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: source quality and accuracy is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: source quality and accuracy is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Sophistication of the interaction analysis — beyond push/pull lists 30%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: sophistication of the interaction analysis — beyond push/pull lists goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: sophistication of the interaction analysis — beyond push/pull lists is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: sophistication of the interaction analysis — beyond push/pull lists is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: sophistication of the interaction analysis — beyond push/pull lists is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.
Partner usefulness, confirmed by feedback 25%	The deliverable is excellent: partner usefulness, confirmed by feedback is met at a standard the partner or audience can use immediately — complete, accurate, well-organized, and genuinely useful.	The deliverable is good: partner usefulness, confirmed by feedback is met; it is usable with minor revisions and its purpose is clearly served.	The deliverable is incomplete: partner usefulness, confirmed by feedback is only partly met — gaps, errors, or unclear organization mean substantial revision is needed before it could be used.	The deliverable is inadequate: partner usefulness, confirmed by feedback is not met; the product is unusable, inaccurate, or missing major required elements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Reflection quality 15%	Reflection is genuinely self-examining: reflection quality shows specific assumptions confronted with evidence, real change or evidenced confirmation, and questions that extend beyond the assignment.	Reflection is substantive: reflection quality shows honest engagement with the student's own thinking, supported by course material, with occasional generality.	Reflection is surface-level: reflection quality is attempted but stays safe or generic — conclusions asserted rather than examined, little connection to evidence.	Reflection is performative or missing: reflection quality shows no genuine self-examination or contradicts the evidence presented.